

DANCE

OVERVIEW

In dance courses at the Grade 11 and 12 level, students continue to learn in, about, and through dance. The medium of expression is movement; the instrument is the human body. Dance education goes beyond the study of a repertoire of movements to offer an understanding of the principles and concepts that govern and define the art. Dance transforms images, ideas, and feelings into movement sequences through innovative choreographic insights. Learning in dance requires a balance of knowledge and skills, and a synergy between intellect, ability, and emotion. Engagement in dance can provide a context for understanding world issues and exploring a variety of cultures. The study and practice of composition provide students with the essential building blocks that support lifelong interest in, appreciation of, and curiosity about dance.

Students refine their kinesthetic awareness and use all of the elements of dance (body, space, time, energy, relationship) to create dance works that explore themes and express ideas and moods. Technique emphasizes the importance of physiological and safety factors while leading to a fuller use of the body and all its parts, stimulating creative and expressive abilities. Students use the elements of movement with increasing refinement, complexity, and variety. They also give attention to development of alignment, balance, correct breathing, flexibility, and strength in creating dance works and performing them safely.

The art of dance should be shared. Students develop performance skills through formal and informal presentations, helping them recognize and communicate both aesthetic and personal values. They learn about the dynamic relationship between process and product. Students also demonstrate an increased understanding of the role of dance in various cultures, societies, and historical periods. They refine their ability to evaluate the quality of performances by critiquing their own and others' work.

The expectations for courses in dance are organized into three distinct but related strands:

1. ***Creating and Presenting:*** Students use the creative process (see pages 15–17) to create, re-create, and present dance composition in a variety of contexts. Creative work in dance involves the realization of exercises, explorations, experiments, dance works, and productions through the refinement of abilities, skills, and competencies. Students demonstrate increased autonomy and innovation in their practice as both choreographer and dancer. They develop personal metaphor and demonstrate their depth of understanding of the creative process. They become increasingly familiar with the tools of stagecraft in dance presentations.

2. ***Reflecting, Responding, and Analysing:*** The critical analysis process (see pages 17–22) involves applying rational and logical thinking to learning in, about, and through dance. Students demonstrate increasing autonomy and ability of all stages of the critical analysis process. They evaluate their own dance work and the work of others, reflect on how dance can enhance both personal well-being and community life, investigate artistic and social influences on dance, and explore possibilities for continuing engagement in dance.
3. ***Foundations:*** This strand encompasses the body of knowledge, understanding, concepts, conventions, and norms that create an underpinning and a context for dance as an arts discipline. Understanding how to move the human body and expanding its movement vocabulary helps students develop insight into how and why people dance. Students examine developments in dance history and dance conventions around the world. At the same time, they expand their awareness of the artistic environment with respect to matters of safety, ethics, and acceptable modes of conduct as an artist, performer, and critic.

For policy guidelines pertaining to focus courses, see pages 12–13 of this document.
The list of approved focus courses for Dance can be found at:
www.edu.gov.on.ca/eng/curriculum/secondary/arts.html.

Dance, Grade 12

Workplace Preparation

ATC4E

This course enables students to develop performance and interpersonal skills through the study of dance. Students will apply the elements of dance and the tools of composition to develop a physical vocabulary that can be used to create and communicate through dance. Students will research and explain how physical, intellectual, and artistic skills developed in the dance arts are transferable to a wide range of careers and workplace environments. They will develop an understanding of practices associated with healthy living, the benefits of self-discipline, and the importance of continuing engagement in the arts.

Prerequisite: Dance, Grade 11, Open

A. CREATING, PRESENTING, AND PERFORMING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. The Creative Process:** use the creative process, the elements of dance, and a variety of sources to develop movement vocabulary;
- A2. Choreography and Composition:** combine the elements of dance in a variety of ways in composing individual and ensemble dance creations;
- A3. Dance Techniques:** demonstrate an understanding of the dance techniques and movement vocabularies of a variety of dance forms from around the world;
- A4. Performance:** apply dance presentation skills in a variety of contexts and performances.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. The Creative Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1.1** use the elements of dance to create dance phrases inspired by a workplace activity or theme (*e.g., combine movements, tempos, and groupings to reflect activities in a specific workplace setting*)

Teacher prompt: “What workplace activity can you think of that requires the kind of body awareness, teamwork, and sense of rhythm needed in dance activities? Can you develop movement phrases that demonstrate those aspects of work?”

- A1.2** create and perform movement phrases that use the elements of dance to express physical or emotional states (*e.g., body movements and accents that reflect the emotions evoked by a piece of music or a natural or urban landscape; patterns and groupings that demonstrate ideas of freedom or constraint*)

Teacher prompts: “What specific types of movement seem to match what specific types of music? How will your movements change depending on whether the beat is fast or slow?” “To what style of music do you feel most comfortable moving? Why?”

- A1.3** use improvisation and the elements of dance to show how movement and body language are used for non-verbal communication in daily life, including in the workplace (*e.g., with a partner, develop a dance sequence that shows a non-verbal “conversation” carried out through movement; develop sequences that use posture and other aspects of body language to depict different personality or character types, or people of different ages and occupations*)

Teacher prompt: “When might you want to use non-verbal communication skills in your workplace environment? What kinds of body language are appropriate in a workplace situation?”

A2. Choreography and Composition

By the end of this course, students will:

- A2.1** use a variety of choreographic forms, structures, and techniques to create and perform a series of movement phrases (*e.g., short pieces for three or four dancers using rondo, AB, or canon form; duets featuring symmetry and mirroring*)

Teacher prompt: “How can you ensure that your group piece will include each individual equally? Does the choice of form make a difference? What form would permit the most equality among dancers?”

A2.2 create and perform movement phrases inspired by a theme of workplace skill building (e.g., *themes such as customer service, organization, teamwork*)

Teacher prompt: “What kinds of body language, movements, and groupings might convey insights about teamwork? About customer service?”

A2.3 identify and use a variety of compositional approaches to communicate ideas and feelings through dance (e.g., *use structured improvisation and a combination of elements to develop a short piece about an environmental concern; use floor patterns and movement vocabulary from two of their favourite dance styles to create a work based on a self-selected theme*)

Teacher prompts: “Can dance be used to address social issues? Can you think of any examples where dancers have used dance in this way?” “What types of movements, rhythms, and structures would help you express the ideas you want to communicate?”

A3. Dance Techniques

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 demonstrate technical proficiency in basic dance vocabulary and the physical conditioning and self-discipline required to support it (e.g., *perform positions and movements requiring alignment, core strength, centredness*)

Teacher prompt: “What type of physical training do you need to prepare for very fast-paced choreography? What type for a dance that requires frequent transitions between high and low levels?”

A3.2 demonstrate familiarity with steps and movements found in a variety of social dance forms (e.g., *perform a dance “collage” for a Parents’ Night that combines steps and movements from ballroom and contemporary social dances*)

Teacher prompt: “What movement differences do you notice between the social dances of you and your peers and the social dances of your parents or grandparents? Can you demonstrate some of the differences?”

A3.3 demonstrate technical proficiency in one or more movement styles and the physical fitness and awareness needed to support it (e.g., *create a piece of choreography that combines or fuses the dance vocabularies of two genres of their choice; perform movement phrases that incorporate aspects of body-awareness training such as yoga or t’ai chi*)

Teacher prompt: “In what ways does your physical understanding of yoga postures and breathing make you more aware of your posture and breathing in everyday activities? How does it change the way you perform various daily physical routines?”

A4. Performance

By the end of this course, students will:

A4.1 rework and polish technique and choreography to achieve an intended effect (e.g., *use feedback from teacher and peers to clarify their intention and polish movement, timing, alignment, and spacing*)

Teacher prompt: “What is the theme of your dance? How do the different movements express the theme? Are there any movements that don’t seem to fit with the overall idea? How could you fix that?”

A4.2 choreograph and perform dances to meet the needs of a specific community audience or event (e.g., *a retirement home “social”, an environmental awareness event, a cyber-bullying awareness session*)

Teacher prompt: “What were your objectives in preparing a dance show for this audience? How might you modify the dance for a different audience?”

A4.3 use various methods to communicate through dance in both rehearsals and performances (e.g., *match facial expression to the mood of a particular sequence; maintain awareness of the connection between their movements and the idea[s] being communicated*)

Teacher prompt: “What do you consider to be more important in communicating your choreographic intentions, facial expression or body movement?”

B. REFLECTING, RESPONDING, AND ANALYSING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Critical Analysis Process:** use the critical analysis process to reflect on and evaluate their own and others' dance works and activities;
- B2. Dance and Society:** demonstrate an understanding of how societies present and past use or have used dance, and of how creating and viewing dance can benefit individuals, groups, and communities;
- B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom:** demonstrate an understanding of the purpose and possibilities of continuing engagement in dance arts.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Critical Analysis Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** use the critical analysis process to identify and assign roles within the group and to guide collaborative work (*e.g., use class-developed criteria to assess their own group skills; contribute to peer assessment of group functions; complete teacher-guided reflections*)

Teacher prompt: "What roles are required by this collaborative assignment? What are the responsibilities of the different roles? How will you decide what role(s) to allocate to each group member?"

- B1.2** analyse and compare choreographies and dance works of different styles and periods (*e.g., use mind maps to list characteristics of excerpts from Petipa's Swan Lake and Jean Pierre Perrault's Joe, and identify key similarities and differences between the two works*)

Teacher prompt: "What similarities can you see between these classical and contemporary dance works? What differences can you identify?"

B2. Dance and Society

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** compare the characteristics of popular dance styles (*e.g., krump and breakdance*) and explain their appeal to both viewers and performers

Teacher prompt: "How would you explain your preference for one of these styles? Which is harder to perform? Which is more popular with your peers, and why?"

- B2.2** identify ways in which dance reflects and influences popular culture (*e.g., describe how a variety of urban street dances continue to evolve from, express, and influence the culture of inner-city neighbourhoods*)

Teacher prompt: "What social conditions shaped the emergence of krumping? What are some other dance forms that have developed in response to particular social conditions?"

- B2.3** identify connections between their dance studies and representations of dance in popular culture (*e.g., create a mind map of dance images from films, commercials, television shows, and websites, and use captions to explain how they illustrate aspects of their dance studies*)

Teacher prompt: "How have your dance studies influenced the way you view media representations of dance? What things do you notice that you might have missed before you studied dance?"

B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 identify and describe opportunities for continued engagement in dance as a performer, producer, educator, or audience member (e.g., *identify opportunities for participation in community productions*)

Teacher prompt: “Do you watch dance routines on the Internet? Have you ever posted your own dance routine on the Internet? What other ways can you think of to view or participate in live or broadcast dance activities, now or in the future?”

B3.2 identify and document transferable workplace skills they have acquired through their dance studies, and possible workplace applications of those skills (e.g., *compile a record of the skills developed during task planning, decision making, problem solving, and information gathering for dance activities*)

Teacher prompts: “What did you learn about problem solving while creating choreography in a small group?” “Could the verbal skills you developed while giving feedback to your peers be useful in a professional environment? In what kinds of situations?” “How would maintaining a portfolio of your learning in dance help you in developing a résumé or describing your skills and experience to a prospective employer?”

C. FOUNDATIONS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Physiology and Terminology:** demonstrate an understanding of, and use correct terminology when referring to, the physiology of movement as it relates to dance;
- C2. Contexts and Influences:** demonstrate an understanding of the social and cultural origins and development of dance forms, including their influence on each other and on society;
- C3. Responsible Practices:** demonstrate an understanding of safe, ethical, and responsible personal and interpersonal practices in dance activities.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Physiology and Terminology

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** demonstrate an understanding of the importance of personal wellness and professional conduct for success in endeavours of all types, including career roles, both in the dance arts and in other areas of endeavour (*e.g., how proper diet contributes to energy and stamina; how rest and relaxation alleviate stress on the job; how a correct warm-up supports longevity in a dance career*)

Teacher prompt: “Which foods/substances and activities increase or decrease your personal wellness and effectiveness? What steps can you take to avoid things that negatively affect your health and performance?”

- C1.2** describe the skeletal system as it relates to movement (*e.g., create a display that shows the importance of good posture and efficient movement for effective performance in both dance activities and the workplace*)

Teacher prompt: “What are some techniques for avoiding physical strain during dance activities? How might those techniques be relevant to the workplace?”

- C1.3** demonstrate, and describe using correct terminology, the dance vocabulary of a variety of dance forms from around the world (*e.g., create a game to illustrate the dance terminology of different forms, including forms studied in class*)

Teacher prompt: “What are the key terms used to describe the dances we have studied this year? Why is it important to know the terms for the dance steps, forms, and techniques you have learned?”

C2. Contexts and Influences

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** describe how specific social and cultural factors have influenced the evolution of some popular dance styles (*e.g., connect the development of b-boying or capoeira to circumstances in their society or culture of origin*)

Teacher prompts: “What social factors influenced the development of capoeira as a dance form based on martial arts movements?” “What is the origin of the word *breakdancing*? What type of ‘break’ is being referred to?”

- C2.2** describe the influence of some global issues on dance (*e.g., the influence of globalization on the evolution of dance in various cultures; the focus on issues such as racism, violence, the environment as themes for choreographers*)

Teacher prompt: “Who are some choreographers who have dealt with social or political issues in their work? What are some of the approaches they have used?”

C3. Responsible Practices

By the end of this course, students will:

- C3.1** identify and follow responsible practices while creating, performing, and viewing dance (e.g., *give feedback in a constructive and respectful manner; explain how appropriate behaviour can contribute to success in the workplace as well as in performances and classroom activities*)

Teacher prompt: “Why is it important to watch performances without making comments while the presentation is in progress? How might an inattentive or restless audience affect your own performance in a presentation or a job interview?”

- C3.2** demonstrate collaborative skills in a variety of situations and settings (e.g., *show respect for others by being punctual; fully carry out responsibilities of their own role while observing boundaries between their own and others’ roles*)

Teacher prompts: “What do you feel are some of the important qualities a dance leader must possess?” “Why is it important to work as a team both on stage as a dancer and in the workplace?”

- C3.3** identify and follow safe and ethical practices in dance activities and demonstrate an understanding of their relevance to workplace environments (e.g., *follow correct procedures for the safe use of equipment; do appropriate exercises to guard against strain injuries; maintain appropriate distances from other dancers/workers; report to the class on copyright laws*)

Teacher prompts: “What are some rules for working safely with others in a confined space?” “How does copyright law define the ‘fair use’ of another person’s work? What is the difference between working ‘in the style of’ a choreographer and copying a choreographer’s work?”